

✧ Why am I being asked to take part in this study?

We want to understand how social determinants (i.e., broader social, economic, political, and environmental conditions) interact with individual risk factors (i.e., gender identity, mental illness, family history of suicide) to influence self-harm, suicidal thoughts, and suicide among young people. We are inviting young people aged 16–25 with lived or living experience of self-harm and/or suicidal thoughts and behaviours to take part in this study.

✧ Why are we doing this research?

Suicide is a leading cause of death among young people, but we still know relatively little about how social determinants influence self-harm and suicidal thoughts and behaviours in this age group. Researchers at the University of Birmingham are conducting interviews with young people to explore how social determinants interact with individual risk factors to influence self-harm and suicide, with the aim of informing policies and interventions to help prevent youth suicide and reduce inequalities.

✧ Do I have to take part?

No. It is entirely up to you. If you do decide to take part:

- You will be asked to sign a form to say that you agree to take part (consent form).
- You will be given an information sheet and a copy of your signed consent form to keep.
- You will be invited to a video briefing session with the researcher to discuss the interview, create a safety plan with you, and discuss any concerns/potential triggers in relation to the interview topic.

You are free to stop taking part at any time during the research without giving a reason. If you decide to stop, this will not affect you or your circumstances in any way.

✧ What will happen if I take part?

If you are interested in taking part, please contact Adam at a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk. You will receive an information leaflet, have the opportunity to ask questions, and be given up to 48 hours (or longer if needed) to decide whether to participate. If you agree to take part, you will be asked to complete a consent form.

Participation involves one interview lasting approximately 45 minutes to 1-hour, either online (via Zoom or Microsoft Teams) or at the University of Birmingham.

Before the interview, you will complete a short questionnaire about yourself and take part in a briefing with a researcher to discuss the interview, develop a safety plan, and raise any concerns about the topics that may be discussed.

✧ Will I receive any financial reimbursements for taking part?

You will be reimbursed £20 for your time. This will be in the form of a bank transfer or voucher at the researcher's discretion. If travelling to the University of Birmingham by public transport, travel costs will be covered up to £10.

✧ Will the study help me?

We cannot promise that you will receive any direct benefits from taking part in this project. The project has the potential to inform the development of evidence-based interventions and policies that can address social inequalities and prevent youth suicide at a population level.

✧ What are the possible disadvantages and risks?

We do not expect participation to cause harm, and you will not be asked about your personal history of self-harm or suicidal thoughts. However, because the interviews discuss suicide and self-harm, some people may find the topics upsetting. You can take breaks, pause, or withdraw from the study at any time, and we encourage you to participate only when you feel comfortable doing so.

Before the interview, you will take part in a brief session with a researcher to discuss any concerns, potential triggers, coping strategies, and support contacts. If you become distressed during the interview, we will support you to use your agreed coping strategies and, where appropriate, contact your nominated support person or GP. Confidentiality will only be broken if we believe there is an immediate risk to your safety.

After the interview, you will be offered a debrief and provided with information about support services and suicide prevention helplines.

Please note that the interviews are for research purposes and researchers are not mental health professionals. If you are feeling very distressed or suicidal, we encourage you to seek support from someone you trust, your GP, or a confidential support service.

PAPYRUS HOPELINE UK:	Childline:	Samaritans:
0300 102 2470	0800 1111	116 123
Text HOPE to 88247 pat@papyrus-uk.org	https://www.childline.org.uk/get-support/contacting-childline/	
Age range: Under the age of 35	Age range: Under the age of 19	Age range: None

✖ What happens when the research study stops?

We will collect all the information together and prepare recommendations that can be used by researchers and policymakers to address social inequalities and prevent youth suicide at a population level.

✖ Contact information

If you would like any further information about this study, you could contact:

Name: Adam Chen

Role: Researcher

Email: a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk

✳ What will happen if I don't want to do the research anymore?

That is absolutely fine. Even if you decide to take part now, you can still change your mind at a later stage. Please note that if you choose to stop participating, we will keep all data that has been collected up until that point. Withdrawing from the research will not affect you or have any negative consequences on any of your circumstances.

✳ What if something goes wrong?

If you have a concern about any aspect of this study, you should ask to speak to the researchers who will do their best to answer your questions. The researcher responsible for this project is: Adam Chen a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk. Or you can contact the University of Birmingham's Sponsor Representative via researchgovernance@contacts.bham.ac.uk. In the event that something does go wrong, and you are harmed during the research, and this is due to someone's negligence then you may have grounds for a legal action for compensation against The University of Birmingham but you may have to pay your legal costs.

✳ How will we use information about you?

We will need to use information from you for this research project. This information will include:

- Your name
- Initials
- Demographic details (age, gender, ethnicity, occupational status)
- Contact Details

Your information will only be accessed by authorised members of the research team and those responsible for ensuring the study is conducted properly. Your name and contact details will be kept separate from your research data, which will be identified using a code number. All information will be stored securely, and any reports or publications from the study will be written so that you cannot be identified. Some anonymised data may be retained after the study to verify and support the research findings.

✳ What are your choices about how your information is used?

You can stop being part of the study at any time, without giving a reason. We will keep any data already provided if you choose to stop participating at any time.

✳ Where can you find out more about how your information is used?

You can find out more about how we use your information by contacting the principal researcher for this study, Adam Chen a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk; and/or The University of Birmingham's Data Protection Officer, dataprotection@contacts.bham.ac.uk

✳ What will happen to the results of this study?

Once the study is complete, the findings will be shared with young people, family members/carers, researchers, and healthcare professionals, and published in academic outputs. You will not be identifiable in any reports or publications, and you can choose to receive a summary of the study findings by email.

✳ Who is organising and funding this project?

This study is funded by the Economic and Social Research Council and insured by the University of Birmingham.

✳ Who has checked the study?

All research in the University of Birmingham is looked at by an independent group of people, called a Research Ethics Committee, to protect your interests. This study has been reviewed and given favourable opinion by The University of Birmingham Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics Ethical Review Committee.

✳ How can I find out more about this research?

If you would like any more information before deciding whether to participate, please contact the researcher. The researcher responsible for this project is: Adam Chen a.chen@pgr.bham.ac.uk